Exclusive Publication for LaRoyal Ancestry

RRP – PRICELESS



# THE BULLDOG BROADSHEET

**Royal by Name, Loyal by Nature**

ISSUE 9

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The Howl-lelujah Chorus

## ★ INSIDE THIS ISSUE ★


- **Your Bulldog speaks more than one language, but are you fluent in theirs?**
- **Why some dogs just seem to "get" each other, and when it is better to simply walk on by**
- **The £75-a-year insurance option that actually made me stop and take notice**





## MORE THAN WORDS

**Soon after Christmas, almost like clockwork, the holiday adverts begin. Blue skies. White beaches. Warm evenings. Suddenly we are all thinking about escaping the British winter and swapping grey skies for a little sunshine.**

And, just as predictably, plenty of us Brits travel abroad having made absolutely no attempt to learn the local language.

Instead, we rely on that time honoured technique of speaking English more slowly, more loudly and with increasing confidence, as though volume alone will somehow translate it.

But perhaps we should give our dogs a little more credit.

Because they are already bilingual.

They speak dog, of course, but they also become remarkably fluent in human.

And I would argue that Bulldogs are particularly good at it.

They learn our routines, recognise our tone of voice, watch our expressions, anticipate what happens next and become exceptionally good at communicating exactly what they want from us.

The problem is that while they spend years learning our language, we do not always make quite the same effort to learn theirs.

Our dogs are communicating with us all the time.

They tell us when they are relaxed, worried, excited, uncomfortable, frightened or feeling unwell. They just do it without words.

Learning to recognise some of those quieter signals can help us understand our Bulldogs much better.

CONTINUES OVERLEAF ...

## 1. THE EYES

A relaxed dog will usually have soft eyes and a relaxed expression.

When a dog becomes worried or uncomfortable, the eyes may suddenly widen and you may see more of the whites around them. They may also avoid eye contact altogether.

A change in expression can be one of the earliest signs that something is making your Bulldog uncomfortable.

## 2. THE EARS

Bulldog ears might not be quite as dramatically expressive as some breeds, but they still tell us plenty.

Relaxed ears usually sit naturally. Ears pulled backwards or held unusually tightly can indicate uncertainty, anxiety, discomfort or fear.

Look at the whole dog rather than interpreting one signal alone.

## 3. THE MOUTH

A relaxed dog often has a soft mouth and loose facial muscles.

Lip licking, repeated swallowing, yawning when they are not tired or suddenly closing the mouth tightly can all be subtle signs of stress or unease.

Equally, a change in how your Bulldog holds their mouth can sometimes be an early clue that they are uncomfortable or feeling unwell.

## 4. THE BODY

Body posture tells us an enormous amount.

A happy, comfortable dog generally looks loose and relaxed.

A worried dog may lower themselves, become very still, lean away or shift their weight backwards. They may also suddenly "shake off", as if wet, to release tension after feeling stressed. Some dogs freeze completely when uncomfortable, so stillness does not necessarily mean acceptance.

## 5. CHANGES IN NORMAL BEHAVIOUR

Sometimes the clearest communication is simply that your Bulldog is behaving differently.

Maybe you notice they don't want their breakfast. They stop joining you on the sofa. They are sleeping more. They hesitate before climbing the stairs. They become unusually clingy or unusually withdrawn.

You know your own dog better than anyone *(even your vet)*.

Often it is not one dramatic symptom that tells us something is wrong. It is that small thought in the back of your mind:

**"That isn't quite like them."**

And that is worth listening to.

Dogs do not have the vocabulary to tell us, "My stomach hurts", "I'm worried about that dog", or "My leg feels uncomfortable today".

Instead, they communicate through posture, expression, movement and behaviour.

So perhaps the next time we are planning our winter escape and downloading a translation app for ourselves, we should remember that there is another language worth learning too.

Your Bulldog has probably spent years becoming fluent in you.

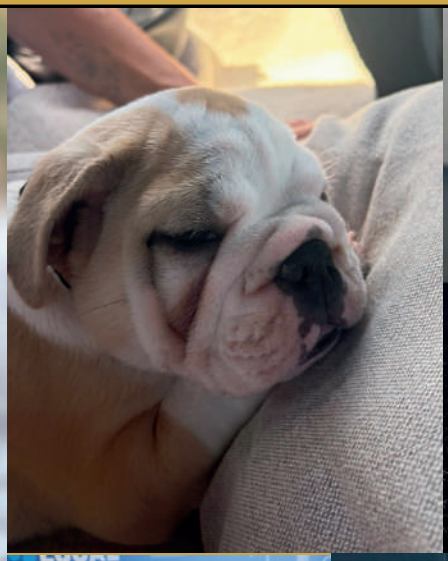
The least we can do is learn a little more Bulldog.



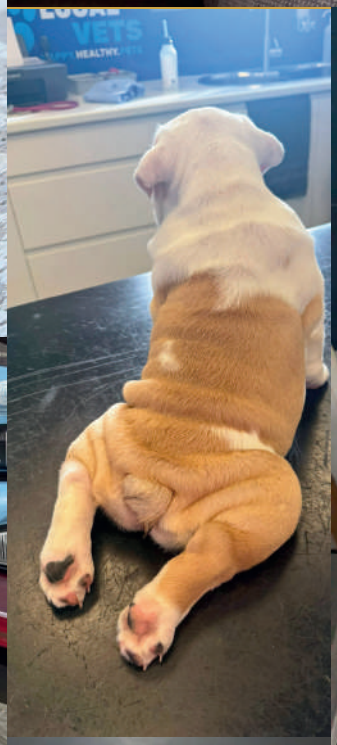
# LITTLE LAROYALS

A glimpse at some of our youngest LaRoyals, from their early days with us to life with their families.









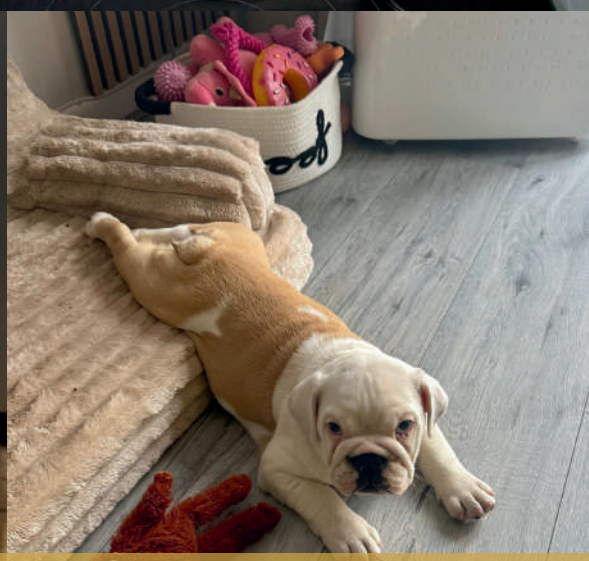












Deposits are now being taken to secure your position on the **Reservation List** for our next planned litters - follow the QR Code.

**Bred with Respect, Reared with Knowledge & Raised as Family**

# THE RULES OF GOOD PLAY

We go on holiday to escape the routine.

We choose the quieter end of the pool, avoid the family with the children doing repeated cannonballs, and quietly relocate when the couple on the next sunbeds continually bicker.

We do not want to talk to everyone. We do not want to sit next to everyone. And we certainly do not want complete strangers invading our personal space just because we all happen to be in the same place.

Our dogs are really no different.

At weekends, we often give them their own version of a mini break. Longer walks, country parks, beaches, pub gardens and more opportunities to meet unfamiliar dogs.

But somewhere along the way, we seem to have decided that a sociable dog should automatically want to greet and play with every dog they meet.

They do not.

A perfectly friendly Bulldog can still look at another dog and think the canine equivalent of:

**“Absolutely not. I’m moving sunbeds.”**

*What does good play look like?*

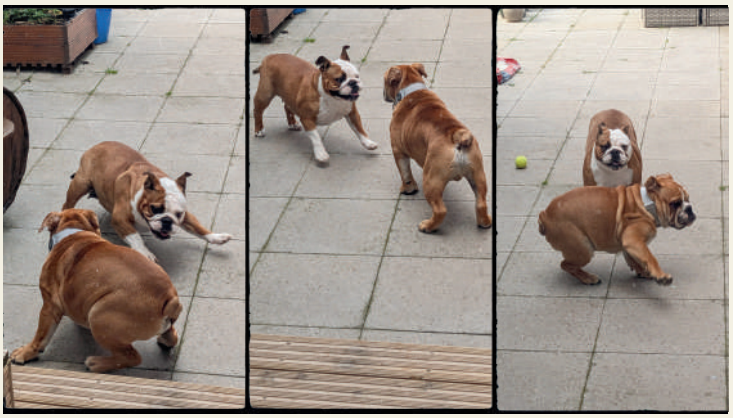
Appropriate play should be balanced.

Both dogs should be willingly involved, with loose body language, exaggerated movements and natural pauses.

You may see play bows, taking turns chasing, swapping roles and both dogs choosing to return to each other after a break.

That last part is important.

If play stops for a few seconds and both dogs willingly re-engage, that is generally a good sign.



If one dog takes the opportunity to move away, hide behind their owner or avoid the other dog, listen to them.

They are telling you they have had enough.

**Know when to interrupt.** Play can change quickly, especially between unfamiliar dogs.

Watch for one dog constantly chasing while the other tries to escape, repeated pinning or body slamming, stiff posture, prolonged staring, mounting, repeated attempts to move away or play becoming increasingly frantic without pauses.

Noise alone does not necessarily mean there is a problem. Some dogs are naturally vocal when they play.

Likewise, a wagging tail does not automatically mean a dog is happy.

Always look at the whole dog.

## PROTECT YOUR BULLDOG

Bulldogs can be enthusiastic players, but that does not mean every style of play suits them.

Repeated high-speed chasing, heavy collisions and rough wrestling may be too much, even if they appear to be enjoying themselves.

They can also tire and overheat more quickly than some breeds.

Give regular breaks, allow them time to settle and do not wait until your Bulldog is exhausted before stepping in.

You are allowed to say no.

CONTINUES OPPSITE (BELOW IMAGE) ...



# A FAMILIAR FACE



There is something comforting about Christmas dinner with family.

You know everyone's habits. You recognise the expressions, the little mannerisms, the shared traditions, the inside jokes and the familiar banter.

Bulldogs have something similar.

When they mix with other Bulldogs, their close French Bulldog cousins, or other brachycephalic and bull breeds, they are often interacting with dogs whose appearance and communication style feels relatively familiar.

Move outside that family, though, and there is more room for misunderstanding.

Dogs communicate enormously through their bodies. Tails, facial expressions, posture and movement all help another dog understand what they mean.

**A Bulldog has rather different equipment.**

There may be very little tail available to signal with. Their shortened muzzle changes their facial expression, and the completely normal snorting, grunting and snuffling that we barely notice can sound very different to an unfamiliar dog. Likewise, your Bulldog may not immediately understand the much more obvious tail, face and body language of another breed.

Neither dog is necessarily being unfriendly. They may simply be speaking slightly different dialects of the same language.

That does not mean Bulldogs should only socialise with Bulldogs. Far from it, or as some would say, *"nae even close"*.

It simply means that when your Bulldog meets an unfamiliar dog, particularly one with a very different shape and communication style, introductions deserve a little more observation.

Watch both dogs. Give them space. Do not force interaction and step in if either begins looking uncomfortable.

After all, most of us can manage Christmas dinner with our own peculiar family.

Being unexpectedly seated between complete strangers is a rather different experience.



**CONTINUED ...**

Your dog does not have to greet another dog simply because somebody says: *"Don't worry, he's friendly."*

Friendly does not always mean suitable.

If the other dog is overly excited, your Bulldog looks uncomfortable, or you do not like the interaction, move away.

Put yourself between the dogs if necessary and ask the other owner to call their dog back.

There is nothing rude about protecting your own dog.

A successful walk does not have to involve making new friends.

Sometimes the best social skill your Bulldog can have is knowing when to walk past.

And sometimes the best thing we can do as owners is recognise when they are trying to say:

***"Not today, thank you."***

# 'TIS THE SEASON FOR COVER

If you are heading off for some winter sun before or after Christmas, you will already know that travel insurance is a must.

It is something you buy hoping you will never need, but when something goes wrong, that relatively small premium can suddenly look like very good value.

Which brings me, rather reluctantly, to pet insurance.

Anyone who has followed me for a while will know I have never been the greatest fan of conventional pet insurance. Premiums rise as dogs get older, excesses can become substantial and cover can reduce just when you are paying more for it.

I have also spoken before about escalating veterinary costs. When there is a large insurance pot available, investigations and treatment plans can sometimes grow in a way an owner paying directly might question more carefully.

That is why I always suggest asking for a **tiered treatment plan**. *What needs doing now? What would be the next step? And what further treatment might only be necessary if the first option does not work?*

My advice has generally been to insure puppies for their first year or two, when they are particularly talented at finding trouble. After that, owners can decide whether to continue with full insurance or self-insure by building a dedicated veterinary fund.



## A MIDDLE GROUND

Recently I came across **Animal Friends Accident Only insurance**, which I think offers an interesting middle ground.

Animal Friends defines an accident as *"a sudden and unexpected event which causes injury to your pet."*

So this is not illness cover. It is protection against those completely unexpected mishaps that can produce a sizeable veterinary bill.

The policy currently offers up to £2,500 per accident, per policy year, with a lifetime limit of £15,000 for each accident, provided the policy continues to be renewed.

For a Bulldog, that could potentially include:

- A **fractured limb** following a fall from the sofa or garden furniture.
- An **accidental eye injury** caused during play or by a badly aimed toy.
- A **cracked or broken tooth** resulting from a toy chomping accident, up to £500 towards dental.

And this is the bit that caught my attention: you also get access to **FREE vet video consults 24/7/365**!

For some dogs, cover can cost around £75 a year, although premiums will vary. At that price, it could be a useful option for owners who are comfortable paying for routine care and illness themselves but still want some protection against the unexpected.

**READ THE SMALL PRINT**

This is accident insurance, not health insurance. It does not cover illnesses or diseases, and there is an excess to pay when claiming.

As with any policy, read the current terms, limits and exclusions before deciding whether it is suitable for your dog.

But for someone who has long questioned whether conventional pet insurance always represents good value, this is one type of cover that actually makes quite a lot of sense to me.

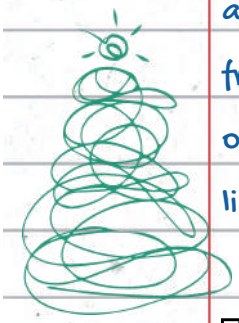
After all, Bulldogs do have a particular talent for creating their own unexpected Christmas expenses.

**SCAN CODE OPPOSITE FOR A QUOTE.**

# My Bulldog Essentials Wishlist



Over the years I've tried a lot of Bulldog products, so I've pulled together the ones I actually use, trust and regularly buy for my own dogs. Pull out this page, pop it on your fridge or pinboard, then simply scan the QR code whenever you need something. Each one takes you straight to my recommended products on Amazon. Some links are affiliate links, so my dogs receive a small commission at no extra cost to you.





**Routine Wellbeing**

Everyday products to support general condition, comfort and ongoing care.

**Wound & Recovery**

Useful items to support comfort, protection and recovery when needed.

**Tried, Tested Bulldog Approved Toys**

Toys and enrichment products chosen with Bulldogs in mind.

**Skin Comfort**

Everyday products for keeping Bulldog skin clean and comfortable.

**Eye, Ear & Nose Care**

Simple essentials for routine Bulldog face, ear and nose care.

**Digestive Upset**

Useful products to keep on hand for occasional unsettled tummies.

**Parasite Prevention**

Practical products for routine flea, tick and worm management.

**Household Hygiene**

Useful products for keeping your Bulldog and home clean and fresh.

**Bowls that Grow**

Practical food bowls for every stage, from puppyhood to adulthood.

**Joint & Mobility Support**

Everyday products to support comfortable movement and healthy joints.

**Puppy Shopping List**

The essentials worth having ready before your puppy comes home.

**Pet Insurance**

Accident Only policy cover with free vet video consults.



# PAWS FOR A CLOSER LOOK

**Think you've got a sharp eye?**

Take a close look at the two festive Bulldog scenes of Joanie and see if you can find all 8 differences.

Some are easy to spot, others may take a little longer.

**Found all 8?**

Scan the QR code to check your answers.




## Christmas Turkey & Cranberry Biscuits



**You'll need**
150g cooked turkey
100g plain flour
50g rolled oats
1 egg
2 tbsp unsweetened cranberry purée

**Bake**
180°C/160°C fan
15 to 20 minutes

**Keep in mind**
Use plain turkey only. No gravy, stuffing, onion, garlic or seasoning.

**How to make them**
Mix everything together into a firm dough. Roll out, cut into festive shapes and bake until lightly golden. Leave to cool completely before serving.

**Storage**
Keep refrigerated in an airtight container and use within 3 days.

## HEALTHY, HAPPY & HOME




"We chose LaRoyal for Sara's experience, knowledge and commitment to breeding healthy, beautiful Bulldogs.

Archie has a wonderful temperament, plenty of character and is everything we hoped for. We particularly valued Sara's openness, support and guidance throughout.

The emails and fortnightly community calls helped us prepare before Archie came home, with continued advice on feeding, grooming and socialisation afterwards.

We would absolutely recommend LaRoyal to anyone looking for a healthy, true-to-breed Bulldog with a lovely temperament.

Denise & Mark"

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